FOUNDERS HOUSE · MASTERCLASS · 20 NOVEMBER

The Know Enough Map.

Bookkeeper, lawyer or ops hire: what does your business need now, and next?

PANEL	NOW: THE HOUSE ISN'T ON FIRE	NOW	NEXT: IF I STEPPED AWAY, WHAT BREAKS?	NEXT	WHO COULD HELP: SMALLEST STEP FIRST	EXAMPLE BRIEF
People	Contracts and right-to-work checks. Payroll and pensions running. Everyone knows their role.	R A G	A hiring roadmap tied to the plan. Every new role answers: why this, why now?	R A G	Payroll provider → HR adviser → people lead	Problem, decision, scope, fee cap: e.g. the fair process for a restructure, no handbook needed.
Finance	Books up to date monthly. You know this month's cash.	R A G	A 12-month cash plan with a 'what if the round is late' case.	R A G	Bookkeeper → accountant → part-time finance director → CFO	Monthly management accounts and a 12-month cash view, for a fixed fee.
Legal	Core contracts signed and read. Data protection basics in place.	R A G	A plan for when something goes wrong, and who you call first.	R A G	Templates → solicitor, one question → specialist	What are the steps, in order, and what is the worst case? No full review.
Commercial	You know your margin. Payment terms in writing. A pipeline you can see.	R A G	Sales that don't depend on you. A forecast for next quarter.	R A G	Freelancer → rev ops specialist → sales lead	Set up the pipeline by stage and a quarterly forecast. Nothing more.
Process	Repeating work is written down. People know where things live.	R A G	If you stepped away, the work still gets done the same way.	R A G	Ops-minded team member → freelancer → operations manager	Map how this gets done today so a new starter can follow it.
Compliance	Filing deadlines known and owned. Insurance in place.	R A G	An obligations calendar someone else owns.	R A G	Accountant or company secretarial service → specialist	Which obligations apply to us, by date, and which are we missing?
Governance	Who can decide and spend what, written down.	R A G	Decisions and approvals that work without you in the room.	R A G	Accountant or company secretary → corporate solicitor → non-executive director	Which decisions need shareholder or board approval under our documents?
Risk	You know the five things that could hurt most.	R A G	Each has an owner, a plan and matching insurance.	R A G	Insurance broker → specialist → operations lead	Given these five risks, are we covered, and where are the gaps?

Draft · general guidance for UK businesses. Not legal, tax or financial advice: it shows how to ask, not when you need advice. When it matters, ask a qualified professional. Watch for being sold more than the brief asks for.

NexaStrategic · Mila Milićević

BACK OF THE MAP

The brief.

1 · THE PROBLEM, IN ONE LINE
What's happening, in plain words.

2 · THE DECISION I NEED
What I'll decide with your answer.

3 · OUT OF SCOPE
What I'm not asking for.

4 · FEE CAP, AND BY WHEN
Budget or fixed fee, and the deadline.

THIS WEEK

One red.

1. Score every row, Now and Next: red, amber or green.
2. Pick one red.
3. Write the brief for it, on the left.
4. Send it to the smallest right person on the ladder.

Not this: "Can you have a look at our contracts?"

This: "Funding is tighter and two teams overlap. We need the fair process for a restructure before we decide whether to start one. We don't need a handbook or policies. Fixed fee, answer by Friday."

Operations Fundamentals takes the whole ball, one panel at a time. Start with OF101.